



HEALTH & TRAVELS PRESENTS

Arizona Family Adventure Starter Pack

Seven easy-to-love adventures plus the tools
to help your crew explore with confidence.

INSIDE

- 7 family adventure ideas
- Grab-and-go packing checklist
- Arizona heat-smart plan
- Kids' scavenger hunt + coloring page

Plan less. Explore more. Make the stories your family remembers.

7 Adventures to Start With

1

Papago Park

PHOENIX | EASY

Try the 0.5-mile Nature Trail or the short Hole-in-the-Rock Trail. Red sandstone, desert plants, picnic areas, and nearby family attractions make this a low-stress first outing.

FAMILY WIN: Let kids choose one desert plant to photograph and identify later.

2

Judith Tunell Trail

SOUTH MOUNTAIN | ACCESSIBLE

Two half-mile hard-surface loops offer smooth footing, very little elevation change, benches, drinking fountains, and covered ramadas.

FAMILY WIN: Perfect for strollers, new hikers, and multi-generation outings.

3

Discovery Trail

LOST DUTCHMAN | EASY

An easy introduction to the Superstition Mountains with a wildlife pond, bird feeder, resting bench, and memorable mountain views.

FAMILY WIN: Visit early and let children carry their own small water bottle.

4

White Tank Mountains

WEST VALLEY | CHOOSE YOUR ROUTE

Arizona's largest Maricopa County regional park delivers big desert scenery close to the West Valley. Check the current trail map and choose a short route that fits your youngest hiker.

FAMILY WIN: Pair a short walk with the nature center or a shaded snack break.

START SMALL: A happy 30-minute adventure builds more family momentum than a miserable three-hour march. Turn around while everyone is still having fun.

Three Worth-the-Drive Escapes

5

Red Rock State Park

SEDONA | FAMILY-ORIENTED LOOPS

The park's clearly marked, interconnected trail network offers creekside greenery and red-rock vistas. Choose a shorter loop at the visitor center instead of committing the family to the entire network.

FAMILY WIN: Give each child a color mission: find three natural shades of red or green.

6

Watson Lake

PRESCOTT | MIX-AND-MATCH DAY

Granite Dells scenery surrounds options for hiking, birdwatching, picnicking, fishing, and seasonal paddling. This is ideal when your family wants an adventure without everyone doing the same activity.

FAMILY WIN: Pack lunch and make the lake your base camp for a flexible half-day.

7

Catalina State Park

TUCSON | EASY TRAILS UNDER A MILE

The Romero Ruins, Birding, and Nature trails are each one mile or shorter, offering approachable wildlife viewing, desert scenery, and interpretive history.

FAMILY WIN: Pick one short trail, then celebrate with a picnic instead of adding miles.

BEFORE YOU GO: Conditions, fees, access, and closures can change. Always open the official park page on the morning of your trip and confirm that the outing still fits your group.

The Grab-and-Go Checklist

Print this page and keep it near your hiking gear.

WATER + FUEL

- ☐ More water than you expect to need
- ☐ Electrolytes for warm or longer outings
- ☐ Easy snacks: fruit, nuts, sandwiches, or bars
- ☐ A small trash bag - pack out every wrapper

SUN + WEATHER

- ☐ Broad-spectrum sunscreen
- ☐ Brimmed hats and sunglasses
- ☐ Lightweight layers
- ☐ Weather and trail-closure check before leaving

NAVIGATION + SAFETY

- ☐ Downloaded map or printed trail map
- ☐ Fully charged phone and backup battery
- ☐ Small first-aid kit
- ☐ Tell someone where you are going and when you'll return

KID COMFORT

- ☐ Closed-toe shoes with good grip
- ☐ Whistle attached to each child's pack
- ☐ Bandana or cooling cloth
- ☐ One simple game: scavenger hunt, bingo, or photo mission

Family habit: refill water bottles and restock snacks as soon as you get home. Future-you will be grateful.

Arizona Heat-Smart Plan

Desert heat deserves respect. More than 200 hikers are rescued from City of Phoenix desert and mountain parks each year. Make the safe choice before the trail makes it for you.

1

CHECK

Check the forecast, park alerts, fire restrictions, and extreme-heat trail closures before leaving home.

2

TIME IT

Choose cool hours. In hot weather, select a different activity or postpone - especially with young children.

3

HYDRATE

Begin hydrated, carry ample water, sip regularly, and turn around before your supply is half gone.

4

WATCH

Stop for headache, dizziness, nausea, unusual fatigue, confusion, or worsening cramps. Seek emergency help for confusion, collapse, seizure, or loss of consciousness.

5

TURN AROUND

The summit, viewpoint, or mileage goal is optional. Getting everyone home safely is the adventure win.

EMERGENCY: Call 911. Move to shade, cool the person quickly, and follow dispatcher instructions. Do not leave a person with suspected heat illness alone.

Kids' Arizona Trail Hunt

Find what you can without touching wildlife or leaving the trail. Draw, photograph, or check off each discovery.

☐ A saguaro with arms

☐ Three different rock colors

☐ A bird call

☐ An animal track

☐ Something shaped like a heart

☐ A shady resting spot

☐ A yellow flower

☐ A prickly pear cactus

☐ A cloud that looks like something

☐ A trail sign

☐ A tiny insect

☐ A view worth remembering

TRAIL PROMISE: I will stay with my grown-up, leave plants and rocks where they belong, give wildlife space, and carry out everything I bring in.

COLOR YOUR ARIZONA ADVENTURE

Bring this family trail scene to life with your favorite desert colors.



Plan Your Next Family Day

Adventure: _____

Date and start time: _____

Who is coming: _____

Weather forecast: _____

Parking / fee / pass: _____

Turnaround time: _____

Post-adventure treat: _____

YOUR ONE JOB: Choose one adventure, pick a realistic start time, pack tonight, and go make a story. The best family tradition starts with the first trip.

OFFICIAL PLANNING SOURCES

[City of Phoenix trails and heat safety](#)

[Papago Park trails](#)

[South Mountain trails](#)

[Arizona State Parks family hiking](#)

[Red Rock State Park](#)

[Watson Lake - City of Prescott](#)

[White Tank Mountain Regional Park](#)

This guide is for general inspiration and does not replace current park notices, weather forecasts, trail maps, or medical advice. Conditions change; verify before every outing.